

Tours & Travels Website

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to define the software requirements for a new Tours & Travels website (name not decided yet). It outlines the functional and non-functional requirements, technology stack, and third-party integrations necessary to build a platform tailored for Indian travel consumers.

1.2 Scope

The system will be a comprehensive, mobile-first web application designed to showcase tour packages, capture leads, and facilitate bookings. Key offerings include Cultural & heritage tours, Trekking/adventure tours, Beach & leisure tours, Luxury tours, and Religious & pilgrimage routes. The platform will heavily prioritize mobile responsiveness, direct WhatsApp communication, and Razorpay payment integration to drive conversions.

2. Overall Description

2.1 Technology Stack

The platform will utilize a modern Javascript-based stack designed for performance and SEO:

- **Frontend:** Next.js for SEO-friendly SSR/SSG and fast rendering.
- **Styling:** Tailwind CSS for a highly customizable and responsive design.
- **CMS:** Sanity or Strapi for easy management of tour packages and blog content.
- **Backend:** Node.js + Express for a lightweight and fast API layer.
- **Database:** PostgreSQL to reliably store structured booking and tour data.
- **Authentication:** NextAuth for secure and easy integration.
- **Hosting:** Vercel for the frontend, combined with Supabase for the database and authentication.
- **Version Control:** GitHub.

2.2 User Characteristics

The target audience primarily consists of Indian users, with over 70% expected to browse via mobile devices. Users prefer direct messaging (WhatsApp) over traditional web forms and require localized payment options (UPI, Net Banking).

3. Functional Requirements (System Features)

3.1 Core Navigation & Pages

- **Home Page:** Must include a hero banner with a Call-To-Action (CTA), featured tours, and customer testimonials to serve as the initial brand hook.
- **Tour Packages Catalog:** A card-based layout displaying all offerings, equipped with filters for region and type.
- **Tour Detail Pages:** Deep-dive pages for specific packages featuring detailed day-by-day itineraries, inclusions/exclusions, pricing, and photo galleries.

- **Booking / Enquiry Flow:** A multi-step form to convert visitors, capturing dates, traveler count (PAX), and preferences.
- **Content Pages:** About Us (team, story, certifications), Blog/Travel Tips, Gallery (grid/masonry layout), Contact/Enquiry, and an accordion-style FAQ section.

3.2 High-Priority Features

- **Search & Filter:** Users must be able to filter tours dynamically by destination and type
- **WhatsApp CTA:** A floating WhatsApp button must be present on all pages for immediate user contact.
- **High-Quality Visuals:** The site must support optimized photo and video galleries to showcase destinations, they will be provided by the client.
- **Social Proof:** Display customer testimonials featuring reviews, photos, and ratings.
- **GST Invoicing:** The system must generate GST-compliant invoices (5–18% tax) for Indian B2C travel bookings.

3.3 Medium & Low-Priority Features

- **Marketing Tools:** Seasonal deal banners to highlight festival/peak season offers.
- **Support & Utilities:** An emergency contact page detailing helplines and local office numbers during active tours.

4. External Interface Requirements

4.1 Payment & Invoicing Integrations

- **CashFree:** Primary payment gateway required to support India-first payment methods like UPI, cards, and net banking.

4.2 Communication Integrations

- **WhatsApp Integration:** Utilization of WATI or the WA Cloud API to handle user enquiries.
- **Email Services:** SendGrid to manage reliable transactional emails for bookings and enquiries.

4.3 Mapping & Media APIs

- **Google Maps API:** Required to embed maps and provide the best location coverage for Indian destinations.
- **Cloudinary:** Auto-optimization and delivery of high-resolution travel photography.
- **Instagram Basic Display API:** To showcase real trip photos dynamically via social media feeds.

5. Non-Functional Requirements

5.1 Performance & Usability

- **Mobile-First:** The UI must be explicitly designed for mobile devices given user demographics.

- **Speed:** Next.js and Cloudinary must be configured to ensure rapid load times for content-heavy pages.

5.2 SEO & Analytics

- **Tracking:** Implementation of Google Analytics 4 (GA4) and Hotjar to track traffic, user behavior, and drop-off points.
- **SEO Tools:** Google Search Console and Semrush to monitor rankings for destination-specific keywords (e.g., "Kerala backwater tour").
- **Local SEO:** Integration with Google Business Profile for local listing and office location mapping.
- **Structured Data:** Schema markup (TourPackage, Review, FAQ) to enable rich snippets in search results.

5.3 Trust & Credibility

- **Reviews Integration:** Embed Google Places API for Google Reviews.